under the guidance of God. But the world is an adjunct and not a transformation of Him. Though atomic, the *Jīva* can perceive far-off things because it possesses attributive intelligence *(Dharma-ghūta-jñāna,* also attributed to God). It is essentially sentient and self-revealing. The souls are intrinsically happy: only past deeds *(Karma)* compel them to transmigration and suffering. God is self-existent, all-knowing, and all-powerful. He is the sole unchanging cause of the universe.

Knowledge, it is maintained, always reveals a complex object, hence, the falsity of conceiving *Brahman* as *Nirguṇa,* or featureless. Knowledge is necessarily true, even erroneous apprehension being true as far as it goes.

The end of life is to attain the perfectly free and blissful world of *Nārāyana. Prapatti,* or complete self-surrender to Him, and *Bhakti,* or loving meditation based upon highest knowledge, are the means to it.

The Advaita

This doctrine, like *Viśistādvaita,* is theistic and identifies God with Nārāyan or Vishnu. But it is more explicity pluralistic inasmuch as individual souls and physical objects are both treated as distinct from one another. *Bheda,* or uniqueness, according to this system, is manifold. There is a difference between God and Soul, between the different Souls, between Soul and Matter, and between the discrete material objects. The majesty of God is taken as the basis of His being distinct from the world, which He completely controls. God is the only independent entity recognized: hence, It is no ordinary pluralism. He is conceived as the all-controlling personality. The evolution of *Prakṛiti,* conceived as the ultimate source of the physical world, is explained through the theory of *Sadāsat-kārya-vāda*—that before its production, the effect is both existent and non-existent in the cause.

Knowledge, it is maintained, is due to a transformation of the internal organ *(Manas)* and not of the Self. All knowledge, even erroneous knowledge, points to an object beyond itself. Truth is correspondence with outer reality or the apprehension of an object just as it is *(Yathārtha-vāda).*

The aim of life is described as the dispelling of ignorance *(Avidyā),* which obscures the true nature of the Self and God. When that is achieved, life is all bliss, although it is strictly proportionate to the intrinsic worth of each Self. The means recommended for the attainment of this state of perfect bliss are the knowledge of